

Thurs Jan 18

One week in Port Antonio - it was enough, even though the beer was cold, the fresh food delicious, the surroundings lush. The place has become very run down. Only a few boats in the harbor. We took a raft trip on the Rio Grande river - poled on a bamboo raft. It was nice to see the countryside. It is a good harbor - we weren't quite ready for the waves and swells outside. Beat to windward in 10-15 knots along the coast - kind of bumpy. Will hear off when we pass Morast Point. Charlotte is flying! The eke and breadfruit we had for dinner last night was excellent, along with Dragon Stout. Baund for the San Blas Islands.

Fri Jan 18

Since we had forgotten, we got a rude reminder of the Caribbean wind and seas! Nice sailing last night - beautiful stars, broad reach in 15 knots, until we went under the squall line. Then bam - wind turned ESE, picked up to 25-30, and stayed there all day. Down to reefed mizzen and deeply reefed genoa. Not what we had hoped for. All we can do is lie around and try to eat. Brian won't leave the aft cabin. The sea is pretty though, with all the booming waves. When the boat goes over 7 - 7.5 knots, the motion get violent and we have to shorten sail.

Sat Jan 19

It's rough you can't be outside without taking a shower. Beautiful sunny weather though! Speed 4.5 - 5.5 knots, with same sail - reefed mizzen! and reefed genoa. Can't do anything. Brian is feeling better today, still not eating much. The crew lines broke today.

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Jan 20 2002

Then more wind this morning - 30-35 knots, big seas. Since we have 200 miles to go, we decided to slow the boat down and so we arrive Tuesday morning. Reefed the genoa down to hankchief size and put a second reef in the mizzen. Still taking occasional breakers over the boat. It's impossible to be out side without getting soaked. There is nothing to do but lie around. Sailing is so much fun!

Mon Jan 21

A nicer day altogether! The wind turned NE last night so we are off the wind. Brian is his usual self again! It's down to 20+ today - sailing along with the same tiny sail rig at 4 knots so we will arrive at San Blas tomorrow after sunrise. We were able to spend on deck today and enjoy the fresh air. Took a big breaker onto the boat this morning - soaked the chart table - got to do something about that. We have learned a lot about Charlotte and sailing in wind on this trip, although the lesson has been uncomfortable!

Tues Jan 22

Beautiful land fall, after a long uncomfortable rolly night. We saw a lot of ships at one point, must have been crossing the Canal shipping lane. Finally hoisted the main again as we approached Holandes Cayes. Decided that weather clothes will help keep water out of the boat. It's beautiful here - our first land fall in a new place - finally breaking new ground with Charlotte! It is very sunny and the sun is hot. Water is all colors of blue - islands covered with palms trees. 550 mile sail - $4\frac{1}{2}$ days.

Sat Feb 2

Enjoyed our stay in the San Blas islands - anchored at Holandes Cayo, Green Island, and Chickimé. Good windsurfing at Green Island. Bought some melao, enjoyed the Kuna Indians - very gentle and friendly. They had very nice dugouts, sailed some of them. The islands were green, palm-covered, the water blue like the Bahamas, beautiful reefs, but very few fish. Met the Austrian boat Idemo with Robert, Engel and 5-yr Anna aboard. Had some pleasant day sails around the islands. The weather was overcast - more towards the mainland. On the outer islands, the reefs crashed constantly and everything was salty.

Left early this morning for Portobelo. 3 other boats left too, it was a superhighway along Panama's north coast! Boisterous sailing, 20-25 knots, beam reach, reefed genoa, reefed mizzen, double-reefed main. We kept up pretty well with the bigger boats. Finally got to see the green hills of the Panama coast towards the end of the trip. Coast is rocky, mostly deep to shore, but with numerous off lying reefs. Not a place to sail at night! Portobelo is a beautiful natural harbor - plenty big for a fleet of Spanish galleons! 55 miles in 8 1/2 hours, over 6 1/2 knots average.

Wed Feb 6

Downwind sail to Colon today - nice sail for a change, no waves on deck! The coastline is green and rugged. Entering the breakwater at Colon was exciting. Big nasty town.

We loved Portobelo - most beautiful anchorage we have ever seen. Three forts guarding the entrance from all sides. We climbed to the top

of one fort, took a short dinghy ride up a river. Peter's boat Tiamat was there - we met him in Brazil - but he had died two weeks before. We enjoyed the little town, felt comfortable standing around drinking beer.

Now the real hustle begins.

Tues Feb 19

Well our stay in Colon was a lot more fun than we expected. It helped that we met some people! In particular, Lady Starlight with Kelcey, Jim, Chris, and Nicholas who is Brions age. He was off at the yacht club every afternoon, so Thomas and I had a lot of time alone together, which was very nice. They bought a new out board motor - 4 HP Yamaha. We enjoyed the street food of Colon, although it was a filthy city. Must have been nice at one point - many sidewalks were tiled, indications of past glory. It was easy to get around though, and people were friendly and helpful, proud to have our business for the most part. Transited the canal today, rafted to a French boat (Canai). Had 3 American line handlers on board - only Ken, the boat number, knew what he was doing. It was all right when the French boat was steering us along the tugs, as their pilot was competent. But when Thomas had to do the steering, the wind and current rammed us into the side wall. Broke the stanchion Don had welded, scraped the side but no paint lost. We roared through Lake Gatun under major and genes, going as fast as we were able. It was very interesting, sailing through the middle of Panama! Had a wait a long time at the last locks, so we didn't clear them until after 6. It was 8pm, completely dark, by the time we anchored at Flamenco Cay. What an experience! No need to repeat it soon.

Wed Feb 27

Finally leaving the Panama Canal Zone! Left this morning from Flamencos Cay anchorage for Las Perlas. Light wind, but pleasant sailing at 3-4 knots, full sails, no rolling! After 3 weeks of rolling with pilot boat wakes, it is a pleasure.

Panama City was BIG! Buses were confusing, taxis comfortable but more expensive. We got what we needed there - spear gun, spare parts, assortment of older Americans and European single handers. I had my loose tooth pulled. The usual word picked up later in the morning and we had a great sail in calm - Pacific! - waters, through the islands, to Contadora. Deep anchorage - 40 feet.

Wed March 13

Well Las Perlas was not exactly what we expected. Contadora was rilly and uncomfortable, so we moved 15 miles to Viveros Cay. Pretty anchorage, surrounded by beaches and little islands, but the murky water was disappointing - spearfishing out of the question. Then Thomas stepped on something in the shallow water and got the most horrific infection. He was in pain, couldn't walk for 3 days, and his foot kept getting worse. Meanwhile Brian and I enjoyed walks on the beaches at low tide and had fun scrambling around on the rocks. The shells were mostly scallops, purple and orange. Beautiful views across the islands from some shady rock under a tree. I really enjoyed the solitude there - no one but small local fishing boats, gorgeous skies at night. We finally went back to Contadora on Thurs Mar. 7 and luckily there was a doctor there. Thomas was in for 5 days of shots, heavy anti-biotics, and his foot slowly started to heal. Very nice young doctor - Cresmo Perera, who was interested in our plans and gave us some

indication to take with us. We got used to touristy Contadora - usually just a sleepy town - and had our routine of afternoon beer and beer at the local mini super. Very dry though - no water - I now wash what I can in sea water. We enjoyed our waiting time as best we could.

Now Thomas is almost completely healed and we are under way for the Galapagos! Left this morning, after a favorable wind report from boats on the way. We have been sailing past the Perles all day, under full genoa and then spinnaker. 12 knots wind NNE, heavy seas, beautiful sailing, the boat is upright! Good omen this morning - we saw a perfect rainbow circle around the sun. Panama was a pleasant surprise, really enjoyed the scenery, the friendly people, the great food, the cheap beer! Could have stayed longer if that was our plan. For now, we are happy to be underway again, with a fair wind. The Pacific truly lives up to its name, at least at these latitudes!

Thurs Mar 14

Here we are, cruising along at 5.5 knots, under spinnaker and mizzen. After Thomas is happy - no sail chafe, and he has always wanted to fly the mizzen drifter since it is so weird. It works great on a good reach. Winds just turned more easterly and are filling in at 6-8 knots. Last night we had an incredible ride - 8.5, surfing in it, for several hours in 20+ knots, broad reaching. The boat was so fast it was almost scary, but the crew steered well. The wind died down this morning for a while. All in all it has been very pleasant. Lots of sea life, not sure what we are seeing. First 24 hr run 148m.

Fri Mar 15

Ran under our funny rig until the middle of the night when the wind picked up. NE winds, 15-20, full sail, boomed out genoa, 5+ knots. Got a bit rally for awhile. Weather report is favorable, same wind tomorrow. All happy on board. 24 hr run - 117 m.

Sat Mar 16

Well so much for weather reports! Very light wind last night, lashed and rolled, down to 2 knots. More of same today, slightly more wind. Spinnaker flying. It is comfortable when we don't roll, hardly know we are at sea. We are well rested, nothing going on at night. Put a spreader chafe patch on the main sail this morning. 24 hour run - 106 m.

Sun Mar 17

Another slow night, averaged 3.5 knots, but wind came up some in the morning. Now it is dying again. At least we continue to move! Spent the day working on a crew list in 3 languages. Brian is getting adept at the computer. The water is blue here, and we must have some current. 24 hours run - 97 m.

Mon Mar 18

It got worse. Totally becalmed for hours last night - we just slept. Wind came up at 3 am from the south so we took down the pole. 3-4 knots in 6 knots of wind - amazing Charlotte can move at all! Now we are motoring because Thomas is impatient. It's really horrible. 24 hour run - 75 m.

Wed Mar 20

Three 24-hour run - 80 m - nothing more needs to be said. Can you believe - head winds! We alternate between sailing south or west and motoring. Big swell from the SW hampers our progress. Kind of frustrating. 24 hour run - 87 m.

1111 Mon 22, 2002

Landfall this morning at sunrise! We motored all night in calm water. It was a bummer, but we're here and San Cristobal is beautiful. Dolphins playing, sea lions on the beaches, huge eagle rays lying on the surface, looking like sharks with double fins. Kicker rock looks like a big foot. We drop anchor in Week Bay around 11, a number of boats we saw in Panama are here. Everyone is friendly.

1111K Apr 1

It has been a fun 10 days in Puerto Baquerizo Moreno. We really enjoyed the town and harbor. The sea lions were constant entertainment, swimming and playing around the boats, climbing upon every possible surface. We had to pick up the dinghy every night or they would have sunk it. We went on a land tour to El Junco and Puerto Sudamerica II. Our taxi driver Carlos took us to a friend's house, using banana leaves over our heads like umbrellas. It was the high light of the day - so peaceful in the fields, with the birds singing and a view of the east coast of the island. We drank cheap beer at a panaderia and got to know all the local shopkeepers. Made friends with Steve & Sharon on Poet's Place and went to Genoa on Candlewin. Visited the Interpretive Center and learned about the history of the Galapagos. We saw blue-footed boobies playing for fish behind the boat, lava lizards and marine iguanas basking in the sun on the lava rocks, very prehistoric looking. We were amazed at the lushness of the island - everything grows in the rich volcanic soil.

Tues Apr 2

Weird night, drifting west with the current. Motored at sunrise, just went to get there. Went close to Isla Tortuga, sunken volcano crater, half moon out of water, cool to look at! Puerto Villamil at Isabela is beautiful, tucked between some lava islands and the shore, with sandy beaches and palm trees. The little islands contain all kinds of wild life - Galapagos penguins, small, black & white, very awkward and funny on land, blue-footed boobies with their unbelievable bright blue feet, marine iguanas looking like prehistoric monsters, and of course sea lions! There is a turtle hatchery a short walk away and a lagoon full of pink flamingos. Fascinating! Plus lots of boats, parties on the beach. We love it here!

Sun Apr 14

Left Puerto Villamil yesterday afternoon, after a false start. We were chased by the Port Captain and asked to return and check out properly! No big deal - he is really a nice guy. Hard to describe the wonderful time we had at Isabela. Athanor showed by with Becca, 18 and Ollie 8, and their parents Eddie and Eileen. All the boats from Wreck Boy eventually pulled in. Attended a wild party at Jeff & Claudia's house, American and Argentinian living here with their kids. Saw all kind of wild life. Went to the turtle hatchery and saw turtles from 1 month to 100 years old. Found a lagoon full of pink flamingos. Took a great horse back ride to the volcano - it was really neat, riding up the outside of the mountain, then walking on the lava fields down into the crater. It was like a moonscape - mostly black but other colors when the sun shone on it. Some deep chasms were still smoking, ferns growing in

them. This one had erupted in 1969. We passed another crater on horse back that is the second largest volcanic crater in the world. Very interesting day. Brian went again, with the other kids. He had such a good time, playing all day on the beach. We barely saw him! One day we went dinghying with Gen and Sherry on Reflection, helped a sick tortoise that was covered with oysters. I thought he was dead at first. Brian and I saw her again 2 days later, swimming normally and able to dive. We got very close to some penguins. Another day I actually touched one that was sitting on a rock! They were all standing there, stretching their stubby wings, wearing their flock and white tuxedos! Brian and I went on an early morning walk on the lava islands and saw hundreds of iguanas, almost stepped on them. Got into a routine of walking to town at 4 pm for a delicious home made pastry fresh from the bakery and an ice cold beer. Decided not to go to Easter Island with Greg & Genoa on Candlewin - we need to stay with Attenor for Brian. We will miss those guys though.

It was hard to leave Isabela, with the incredible wildlife and the renewed social life. But I was rewarded with the sight of a school of 100 dolphins yesterday before dark. They were leaping 10 feet out of the water - amazing - so many at once! Had a squall last night, good wind, then it was light, did 3 knots. Now we are motoring for a few hours to try to get into the wind. Galapagos, we love you! 24 hours ~~run~~ - 89 miles

Mon Apr 15

Trade wind sailing - yeeh! We picked up wind in a squall yesterday afternoon and it has stayed with us. Last night was beautiful, flat sea, sky blazing with stars, Charlotte charging along at 7 knots. We are still going strong in 15-18 knots South winds, forward of the beam, full sails 6-7 knots constant. Saw Athenor last night just before sunset, last seen finally. Ran the Coconut Breakfast net this morning - interesting to see how all the boats are spread out. Just about everyone has got wind by now. 24 hour run - 138 miles

Tues Apr 16

Yesterday was a great sailing day - hit over 8 knots at times, Charlotte really charging along. Unfortunately it changed today - variable winds, lumpy seas, speed up and down. Wish it would settle in again. Life proceeds on board - schooling takes up most of the day. No time to read anymore! 24 hour run 143 miles

Wed Apr 17

Got into the groove last night - 55 miles in 7 hours! Today the wind turned more ~~east~~ so we are poled out, consequently going slower. Thomas spotted 2 whales - we got to see just the wake, going very close to the boat. Trade wind weather today - blue sky, cumulus clouds, 15-20 knots. 24 hour run 148 miles

Thurs Apr 18

Started getting some squalls with more punch to them, finally just leaving a reef in the main for now. Could use more sun, but otherwise no complaints, we are just rolling along. Thomas caught the world's record smallest dorado today. 24 hour run - 148 miles

Fri Apr 19

Good wind today, 20 knots SE, reef in all the sails, 6.5-7 knots steady. A bit boisterous for head making! Caught a tuna just before dinner last night. 24 hour run - 165 miles
Thomas saw 2 pilot whales.

5:15 Apr 20

The decks looked pressure washed after the torrential rains we had last night! Sails are clean too. It was no fun at the time - pole up, pole down, sails in and out. But this morning brought sunshine and calmer seas. The boys had a dinner dorado last night. There was a mayday report on the net this morning, at $4^{\circ}31.6'S$, $111^{\circ}48.7'W$. Bazan, Marewa, and Attenor are diverting to check it out. We are currently sailing due west so we will be south of the position. Hope it's a false alarm! Winds are lighter today - 10-12 ESE, making only 5+ knots. 24 hour run - 136 miles

5:15 Apr 21

Yesterday afternoon we set up 4 sails - poled out genoa, staysail, main, and mizzen, got them all flying on a very broad reach, reeled off the miles all night long. Took it down this morning when the wind picked up, but it was a nice rig. Saw a small school of dolphins just after sunset - they played in the bow wave for a long time, leaping into the air and doing backflips. Today is boisterous, 20+ knots, trade wind weather, rolling. 24 hour run - 151 miles
Celebrated $\frac{1}{3}$ of the trip with a big bar of chocolate!

11:15 Apr 22

Beautiful night last night - clear, moon, stars, no squalls. Got to catch up on our sleep. Today the wind has been very light, still moving around 5 knots or less. Back to school is difficult - it takes up a lot of time. 24 hours run - 142 miles

11:15 Apr 23

Cruising with our 4-sail trade wind rig again - 4 sails flying - on a broad reach, 15 knots wind. Squalls slowed us down last night. Brian and I are having fun studying French. The ham radios nets me the high points of our day. 24-hour run - 138 miles

Wed Apr 24,

Nice night, beautiful half moon, no squalls. Today we passed the half way point - will celebrate with spaghetti and red wine tonight. Wind light today 10 knots, seas lumpy. 24 hour run - 147 miles

Thurs Apr 25

Light winds, slow going, barely 5 knots under spinnaker. But Thomas did pull in a 10-lb yellow fin tuna, so they ate well for lunch and have dinner too. Sky completely clouded over now, wind up to 10-11 reaching but still only 5-5.5. Had a peaceful day however, everyone seems content. 24 hour run - 123 miles

Fri Apr 26

Another slow but quiet night. It is very pretty at night with the moon almost full. You seem to see far miles. Kind of squally today, good sailing again, on a reach. 24 hour run - 125 miles

Sat Apr 27

Great night's run - some squalls, had to reef down, but still moved along 15-20 knots of wind. Char lot is in her element! Beam beam (brood) reaching all day under full sail. Dropped under 1000 miles to go - morale has improved! Enjoyed the sunshine today. 24-hour run - 151 miles

Sun Apr 28

It was another beautiful night with the moon so bright. Great sailing last night, 6 1/2 knots average. Today the winds are down, still doing 5 knots with the stay sail up. Sunny day, comfortable on board. Listened in to another net this morning - so many boats out here! We have finally decided to make landfall at Hiva Oa. 24-hour run - 148 miles

Mon Apr 29

Horrible night, rolled constantly, had weird dreams. Today is sloppy and slow, wind is almost north of east. We are running dead downwind. Must expect more of the same.

24 hour run - 126 miles

1111 Apr 30 2002

Calm night, no sail maneuvers necessary. Wind turned a bit south-
ward, so we are not quite downwind any more, less rolly. Beautiful
blue skies, no clouds. We now have an ETE on the GPS - less than
100 hours! 24-hour run - 135 miles

Wed May 1

Happy May Day! Sharon on Poet's Place reminisced about flowers on May Day on the net this morning. Decent night, but the wind has been dropping all day. We are still moving along at 5 knots, incredibly enough. We want to get there! 24-hour run = 135 miles

1/11/2022 May 2

We just dropped under 300 miles to go. Unfortunately we still won't make it before dark on Saturday. Winds are 12-15 knots, very easterly group getting pushed south. Everyone else is having to tack back north to make their destination. 24-hour run - 133 miles

11/11/18 May 3

It was a really nice night - boat sailed smoothly, made good progress. This morning we talked to Wana Caura and Galatea on the radio and decided to change course once again. Now we are making for Huka Hiva - we would have gotten to Hiva Oa at night. Plus the anchorage at Hiva Oa is small and uncomfortable, full of sharks. Another 60 miles, but we can make Huka Hiva Sunday morning. We have to ~~be~~ as the course is now due west, impossible to steer.

24-hour run - 141 miles

566 May 4

This has been the longest day in the history of mankind! Moving along 5 knots, feels like we are standing still. We want to get there now! Head downwind, rolling along. Nothing to do but read books and watch the time pass slowly. It - how far - 121 miles

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What a wonderful 2 weeks in the Marquesas! Brian had a blast for a week with the Athenor kids - we hardly saw him. We took them all a couple of days. Started hiking up the mountain side on the road - paved switchbacks. Finally broke down and started hitchhiking. Got a ride with some locals going to collect bees! They dug a hive out of the side of a hill, smoked the bees out with coconut shell, we gorged on honey. The interior was very beautiful, different vegetation. Taohae was one the the largest towns, were able to find some fruits and vegetables. Lots of boats in the harbor - met Dava & Gui on Galatea, great people. After Athenor left we cruised to Daniel's Bay, great land locked harbor. Hiked to the waterfall with Galatea and Jack & Joyce from 2nd Tri. It was a magnificent walk through the valley, jagged cliffs looming over us. The waterfall was just a trickle, but Brian and I swam in the pool tucked into the rocks - kind of eerie! Daniel was a very sweet old man, gave us green coconuts to drink and we signed his book. The valley was paradise - flowers, fruit trees. The Marquesas can grow anything and the flowers are incredible - hibiscus, frangipana, bougainvillea, gardenia in a riot of colors. Also met the Japanese boat Ori Kalcum with Ken, Yuka, Yumi, Yuki on board - 12-year old girl, very pretty, nice family, very different. We had a great time in Daniel's Bay, partied with Galatea. Then to Ua Pou and Haka hae, the main town. Visited the local museum there and learned about Marquesan history from Pascal. Then to Haka hetau, where Etienne lived. This was our favorite spot - the locals were so friendly to us. I got to practice my French - the Marquesans speak an easy version.

There had a potluck for all the cruisers and everyone did
sings or dances. Were invited to dinner by Jean-Marc, crazy
Frenchman, had a wild time. Got to taste traditional Marquesan
food. It was a beautiful little village. This morning they
welcomed a cruise ship with singing & dancing, flower leis,
food and handicrafts. Got a piece of flower stone and tan wood,
both found only in Ua Pou. It was hard to leave, but the wind
came back today so we are off to the Tuamotus. Idyllic stop in
the Marquesas - we won't forget it. Wind SE, 15 knots, we are
charging along under full sail.

Mon May 21

Had a pleasant quiet night, steady wind but light. It got worse
today! Down to less than 2 knots at times. Just set spinnaker,
going 3.3 now. Flat seas. Very comfortable on board but very hot.
24-hour run - 102 miles (will be much worse tomorrow!)

Tues May 22

Well half the night was nice, under spinnaker, 3-4 knots, but of
course it didn't last! Went under a cloud line at 2am, SW winds,
then no wind. Interrupted sleep, went nowhere. Total stall this
morning, now we have 6 knots from the NE, under spinnaker again,
3.5 knots for awhile, but dropping now. Oh joy. All time slowest day!
24-hour run - 68 miles

Thurs May 23

It's getting tiresome - rain & stall last night, very little wind
today. We are tired of it. Now squalls from the SW, on the nose.
Still too far to go. One good thing - Brian lost his last baby
tooth today!! 24-hour run 63 miles

Fri May 24

Well calm seas don't seem so bad when you are battling 35 knots on the nose! The wind came up at 5pm last night and kept coming. Couldn't keep the course at first. Saw a sailboat just at dusk. It was a wild night, Char bottle falling into holes, had to dump the main completely. No sleep, too rough. Wind has been letting off and backing through out the day, sailing rather pleasantly now, reasonably upright. Didn't do anything all day but lie around and read. 24-hour run 103 miles.

Sat May 25

Nice night, but the winds kept turning south. We can't hold our course today, have to motor sail to avoid hitting atolls! Hope the wind will turn more favorable this evening, we have to hang out all night and wait for the morning's slack tide. We are tired of this trip! Could sail just fine, in another direction.

Tues June 11

It was with regrets that we left Takarawa this morning - we had such a wonderful time there and made so many friends. Some of them are already in Papeete and we will see them there. Athenor stayed another week in Takarawa and the kids played together every day, exploring the motor. Anfidan was there with Rick, Patsy and Jessica, and we got to be friends. Then Oric Halsum came with Ken ichi, Yuko, Yumi and Yuki and Brian played with them for a week. We met Paul & Mary on Aventura, really enjoyed them. Had 2 pet ducks on the beach. Did lots of snorkeling drifting through the south pass. After our landfall on San May 26, we motored through the Boeling cut, it was big

thought to drive an armada through, but still lots of current and standing waves. Then we sailed the 30 miles through the strait to the south pass, where the other boats were anchored. Then we never moved! Diving was great, clear water, lots of groupers, black-tip sharks. Infidien let us use their dive gear to do a scuba dive and see the 'Valley of the Sharks' - 200 sharks in the center of the pass, 110' deep.

Best part of all was meeting Manihi & Tila at Motu Ato, their little resort. We got to be good friends - they were such nice going people. Thomas & Brian went fishing with Manihi, I had coffee with Tila. Thomas worked on their outboard and I did their website. Tila made a fantastic 3-layer cake with peaches and custard for Brian's birthday. Cuventura gave him chocolate, the Japanese gave him marbles, a necklace and fishing gear. We liked getting to know them better - Ken person, I hated to say good by. We had 4 great dinners over there. She gave me a carved pearl and another little thing she made herself, with coral shells and pearls. We have to go back some day - they are our family!

It was a wonderful 2 1/2 weeks. We all got to do some wind surfing. Not much boat maintenance - too much time having fun! The view was so magnificent with turquoise waters, palm trees swaying on the motus, coral and pink sand beaches. Paradise!!
how we are sailing in 15 knots, full sails, broad reach, 5.5 knots, big seas.

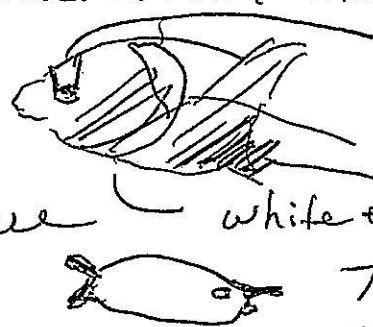
Wed June 12

Nice sailing, 20 knots of wind, 6+ knots, today, after a sloshy night. No problem getting to Papeete tomorrow morning. It is not uncomfortable, but we all agree sailing is boring!

I have to write more about Fakarua. The beaches were a bit disappointing, so what looked like white sand was really coral rubble. There were some beautiful but small, ^{roses} pink sand beaches. Strolling was difficult, walking on the shaggy uneven coral rocks, and there weren't many. The kids had fun making houses under the trees. The underwater coral was healthy, although not a lot of variety, but the fish were incredible. Some of them were almost unreal in their color variations. One especially was very shy, with lots of colors.

It was the only one to see this fish!

I saw an octopus which Thomas tried to spear. The unicorn fish were the only reef fish good to eat.



blue patch with
fleck bands between
eyes

orange stripe

white & gray white & black
stripes

They were dark
colored with a horn.

All kinds of big groupers and snappers were undisturbed, because of ciguatera. The Napoleon wrasse was a kind of giant parrot fish with a big bump on its fore head. We got to swim with the manta rays in the pass one day. Remoras clung to the boat and came after you when you jumped in. I never tired of snorkeling and gazing my eyes on the panorama of palm trees, white coral beaches, water in varying shades of blue. Plus the friendship of Tila & Manihiv.

24-hour run - 128 miles

Thurs June 13 2002

What a great night of sailing! We had to slow the boat down to 5 knots - finally took the main down - so we would arrive in Tahiti at sunrise. It came slowly but we had a great landfall. Entered the harbor after sunrise, motored down to Mueva Beach, anchored near Palatea. We were happy to finally enjoy a good sail - Charlotte was going great.

Mon June 24

Left Moorea last night to sail to Huahine. Very boisterous conditions - confused seas, 20 knots wind, but beautiful sailing with a full moon. Thomas was cursing - it was kind of uncomfortable! Anchored at the village of Fare next to Onfidien - Patty, Rick + Jessica - at 8 am.

We spent little time in Papeete - rushed around buying the things we needed. The city was not thrilling - no bargains to be had, the market was disappointing. Mueva Beach was a comfortable anchorage though. Stocked up on chocolate bars + Nutella. Tuesday morning we sailed to Cooks Bay in Moorea, where we met Athena + Eric Holcum. Cooks Bay is the most breathtaking harbor we have ever seen, with the cliffs towering above, rock spires with holes in the top. Took a great hike with Onfidien to a lookout point and some old Tahitian temple ruins, then scrambled to a tiny peak over looking 2 valleys. Moorea is beautiful but too busy with tourists and lots of cars. Made a chocolate cake for Brian + had all the kids over - what a party! Saw some native dancing - girls shaking their hips, etc.

Thurs June 27

Huahine was pleasant. The little town at the north end was nice, just real people hanging out, Brian & Thomas had a burger. Then we went to the south end with Anfidien. Paddy let Brian & I use the scuba gear, so I took Brian scuba diving. He enjoyed it, was totally comfortable underwater, liked having air to breathe! We walked around the south tip of the island and found an old coral block temple. Not much happening here, but peaceful. Thomas tried windsurfing, too gusty as usual. Sailed to Raiatea today, 20-some miles, light wind, down wind as usual. We sailed right in the pass under poled-out genoa and around the north coast of the island. Propped the hook in deep water - 75' - near the Carenage boatyard. But first we had a close encounter with the bottom, trying to anchor near the reef. The bottom shoals extremely rapidly, from 100' to 5', and we had poor light, were on top of the sandbar before we knew what was happening. Luckily we got off without too much trouble, pushing off with the spinnaker pole while running the motor in reverse. Warua Carina is hauled out in the boatyard. Jack & Elsa, the crazy Aussies on their 3rd circumnavigation.

Thurs July 4

Light wind sailed to Bora Bora. Raiatea and Tahaa were pretty and quiet, but the anchorages were too deep. We spent a while at the Carenage, bought new life line stanchions, checked out the local town, hitch hiked around. It was nice, but no wind surfing and no snorkeling. Sailed to the north coast of Tahaa and spent 2 nights totally alone in a small bay. The water was so calm last night the stars were reflected in it.

Wed July 17

Had a great time in Bora Bora - the anchorage was so beautiful. We anchored between the reef and a motu, away from town. Great snorkeling all around. The water colors were fantastic, anchored in 15 feet of water. The peaks of Bora Bora towered behind the motu. Brian got to play with Athenor and Oric Holium kids for 4 days - they spent it all in the water. Saw a javelin throwing contest and the Bastille Day parade. Did Tui come in, nice to see Jack & Joyce again. Now we are on our way west - destination unsure. Spent the last week waiting for a cold front to go through, light west winds. They are south today, cannot hold the course to Rarotonga. Supposed to turn more easterly. Did get to do some wind surfing - Brian and I had fun sailing over stragrays! Saw a couple of eagle rays, several morays decorated like Marquesan like designs, lots of picasso fish. They are the ones I first saw in the Tui motus.

Thurs July 18

Wind finally turned more favorably and freshened around noon today. We are almost holding the course, doing around 5 knots. Thomas and Brian are over their seasickness. Good thing too - 20-30 knots running our way! Still unsure of destination - depends on what tomorrow brings. Wind now south, maybe a bit east, 10-15, instead of SSW, 8. 24-hr run - 105 miles

Fri July 19

Well the wind came up yesterday around sunset and it was a wild night. Gales with 30 knots passed by, very Goiterous, little sleep. Today is better, 20 from SSE. We are reaching at 6 knots, not too uncomfortable. Destination Aitutaki in the Cook Islands.
24-hour run - 136 miles

Sat July 20

Last night was quite nice, wind let off some and we were charging along at 6-7 knots. Had a big dorado before sunset but lost it right at the boat - Thomas was very disappointed. Around 4 am Brian got doused in the aft cabin so we dumped the main altogether. Wind picked up steadily all day. Now we are down to double-reefed mizzen and stay sail, still doing 5-6 knots. Blowing 25-35 SE, but the boat is pretty comfortable. It's cozy inside, no need to be out side! Waves are big 9-12 feet, but far enough apart that they don't break. Will be in Aitefaki tomorrow.

24 hour run - 136 miles

Sun July 21

Still out here - decided to bypass Aitefaki. With the 25-30 knots winds we are having, the shallow narrow cut would be boiling and Thomas didn't want to test our engine on it. We passed the island at sunrise. Guess we will continue on to Niue. Had a beautiful rain before this morning. It's boisterous - 30 knots SE - but we are way off the wind so it's not too bad. Lets off at night. Another 5 days to go.

24 hour run 138 miles

Mon July 22

The wind is becoming tedious now. Steady 30-35 since yesterday afternoon. Last night was really bumpy, no sleep. Today we have 15-foot swell, no reason to be out side. Average speed 5.5 knots. 24 hour run 132 miles

Tues July 23

Wind finally let off last night, got the main back up, genoa poled out - yeah! Beautiful night with the full moon. Have been making good speed today. Sun is shining, everyone is happier. Got some sleep last night. Heard a good report on Niue - will be there by

Thursday sundown we hope. 24 hour run 138 miles

Wed., July 24

Great run last night, beautiful in the full moon - all sails up and flying at 7 knots for awhile. We are happy to have this trip almost over. Talking to Infidians every morning - they will try to get into Aitutaki. Sorry we missed it, but Niue sounds quite interesting. Life is fun when the boat is charging along!

24-hour run - 145 miles

Thurs July 25

Saw Niue at sunrise, tied up to a mooring by 11 am. Wind had turned NE. Stella with John is here, another single hander, Moonlight with Leo. Doesn't look like much is going on. Water is crystal clear.

Mon July 29

Well we will remember Niue for sure - extremely uncomfortable daily anchorage. We had NW squalls for 3 days, luckily they weren't very windy. The moorings were reliable. I took a great snorkel, saw lots of coral snakes, they don't bother anyone. Brian and I had a great 40-km bike ride around the island, looked at caves, deserted villages, tiny beaches along the rocky coast. Niue is a ghost island - they are bankrupt and everyone is moving away. It has its rugged charm. We are glad to be on our way again. Beating into 15 knots SSW winds, but it's more comfortable than at anchor.

Fri July 30

Light wind but we are moving in the right direction. Last night very peaceful - we caught up on our sleep! Wind up to 12-15 now, South, still going rather high. Pleasant sailing though.

24-hour run 106 miles

Sun Aug 1

Lost a day - even though we have not yet crossed the International Date Line, Tonga keeps that time. Another perfect sunrise landfall. We are rounding the north coast of Vavau, will be anchored at Neiafu in a few hours. After a nice night of sailing, wind picked up to 20-25 at sunrise. It is howling over the cliffs now! Looking forward to a peaceful anchorage and cheap beer.

Tues Aug 27

Well there are peaceful anchorages here but the beer is not cheap. We will be renewing our visas today, will stay here until it's time to head for NZ. Vavau has not been what we expected but we are getting used to the reality. It is nice not to be at sea. We met some boats with kids - Flying Cloud with Dave, Sue, boys Ben & Sam; Desert Rose with Mick, Lynne, kids Tedo, Edwinna, Isabel. We have enjoyed socializing with them. Met Bob & Robin on Buster, an American steel boat. Ran into Kuelani & Aju again. We have enjoyed meeting a lot of friendly New Zealand cruisers. Diving is so-so here, wind surfing is good sometimes. There are a lot of anchorages to visit.

Thurs Sept 12

Back in Neiafu - met some people we last saw in Bonaire 11 years ago. Kelleeg - with Tani & Annette. We went diving with them there and she had fun holding Brian. I had a wonderful birthday. Dinner on Flying Cloud, got presents from Becca, Ellie, Yumi and finally Brian! Didn't mention Thomas' Birthday barbeque on the beach with Desert Rose and Flying Cloud - we cooked lamb chops and had a cake under a huge rain tree.

We have been all over Navau, tried to dive Mariners Cave but chickened out. Walked over some reefs to dive outside drop off - pretty, clear blue water. Walked some beautiful soft sand beaches. Weather is improving - it is summer again! Athanas & Oric Halcum are here. Met Neil & Honey on active flight again - going to do some software swaps. For the most part, having a really good time here - good social life.

Thurs Sept 20

Finally got out of Navau! It was fun there, so many kids, it was hard to leave, Brian was so happy there. The whale-watching was probably the highlight of our stay. We got to swim with a gliding mother and her baby for an hour, got right up to them. These were humpbacks, about the size of our boat. It was a magical experience. Brian got to dive Mariners Cave and Swallows Cave a 2nd time with the kids on Navarra. We ran into some old friends from our life, on Lazy Lightening - Relebec. Had a birthday barbeque for Ken-ichi, then he ripped his genoa to shreds just before they left for Fiji. We ended up selling him a spare head sail - it fit his boat perfectly. Hated to part with it, but he had to have it.

We left yesterday around 5pm, perfect sail last night, been reach, calm seas, 6-7 knots. Only problem was slowing the boat down so we didn't arrive too early. Found Flying Cloud immediately of course, but Sue is leaving today with the kids to fly back to New Zealand. Bummer, but at least we can keep Dave company.

Fri Sept 28

Left Uoleva - what a paradise! The beach was fantastic, could walk on soft sand for miles, crystal clear water, coconuts everywhere, no people. Having a great sail out to Hapa today. Great weather, Charlie is really happy!

We caught 2 mahi mahi, one just before we entered the reef at Ita'afewa. Brian and I loved Ualewa - the best beach I have ever seen. Partied with Dave on Flying Cloud and his crew.

Tues Oct 1

After several very windy days, we ventured out and it was still very windy. Flew the 20 miles to Numea, then wished we hadn't left when we saw the anchorage - an open roadstead! Ita'afewa was all right, took a great walk on the beach, found lots of shells. Bought lots of bananas and papayas from some rather pesky locals. Anchored and sailed today with Flying Cloud, Illusion - Bob & Carrie (finally getting to know them) & Aja. Caught another mahi mahi! Charlotte sails well on a reach with genoa and mizzen only, when the wind howls. Numea may be nice in a light SE wind, but in 20K E it is uncomfortable.

Wed Oct 2

Another perfect sail, this time lighter winds, 12-15, perfect sailing, 6 knots with the main up. Illusion & Flying Cloud were right behind. 20 miles to Kelepesia Island, totally off the beaten path, really paradise (except for the obnoxious flies). A tiny island surrounded by reefs, with a great rock to climb, beautiful view of the crystal turquoise water. All the coconuts you want. Will stay as long as we can.

Sat Oct 5

We enjoyed Kelepesia, while the weather was calm! The water was incredibly clear. Had a nice party on Flying Cloud, with Illusion, before they left. When the wind came up from the SE, there were breakers all around the anchorage, even in the entrance channel. It made us a bit nervous, and was kind of uncomfortable.

Would have liked to stay longer, but needed some sleep! Enjoyed exploring the island, picking coconuts. Left early this morning, rather hairy going past the breakers, Allusion got caught in one and slammed really hard. It was a balistrous sail to Nukualofa, we were side-by-side for hours. Amazing how our boats are evenly matched in speed. Nice to be in a real harbor, flat calm, next to a small motu.

Sat Oct 12

Left Nukualofa this morning, it has been blowing 25+ for several days, anchorage was getting choppy. Enjoyed looking at all the Tongans in the city, studying their facial characteristics, they are such big people, good at a row, mat, sandals. No one wears shoes in Tonga! City was quite nice, very confused seas, been reach, rather uncomfortable. Great speed, 16 knots. Goodbye South Pacific! We will miss you.

Sun Oct 13

Beautiful day - we are dead downwind with full sails, lots of sunshine, it's great to be hot! Only problem is boat speed, down to 14 knots. More comfortable though, everyone is feeling better. 24-hour run 132 miles

Mon Oct 14

Funny ocean - stirred up and wild one day, flat calm the next. The wind suddenly fizzled out last night and we ended up motoring for 12 hours. Entered Minerva Reef at 2 pm. Fidelio and Amantia were there, got a bunch of wahoo.

Tues Oct 15

On our way again, weather report was good. Brian and I wanted to stay and walk on the exposed reef at low tide. North Minerva Reef was pretty weird, with no land at all. It was quite comfortable though behind the breaking reef. 20-25 today, SE winds, rather bumpy but getting smoother. Hope for this all the way, wouldn't be too bad!

Wed Oct 16

Well aren't we lucky! The wind let off and backed during the night, can you believe we are poled out again! We have been running the mizzen stay sail all day, it looks very nice. It's fun to fly it. Rolling some but otherwise it is comfortable. Sunny skies but it is not hot, air is cool. What are you getting into? The water is a beautiful blue, fish are flying, everyone is happy.

24 hour run - 133 miles

Thurs Oct 17

We never expected to be flying spinnakers on the way to New Zealand! Flew poled-out genoa, stay sail, main, and mizzen drifter all last night, did 5 knots, it was beautiful under a waxing moon. Wind started dying at sunrise, started motoring at 12:30. Will shut down the beast this evening to get some rest. At least it's hot and sunny today - we are enjoying that!

24-hour run 110 miles

Fri Oct 18

What a beautiful day! The wind picked up at sunrise and we put up the stay sail and mizzen drifter, great sailing at 5 knots, lots of sunshine, we all enjoyed ourselves. Brian got into a map project, Charlotte doing very well in such light winds. We are reaching again, NW winds. 24 hours run 95 miles

Oct 19 2002

Nothing lasts forever, and today is a different day. Wind turned NW last night, still light, then SW and was blowing 20-25 by sunrise. We are on our ear, can't quite hold the course, basking along. Lots of fun! Oh well, knew we had to get nailed eventually!

24 hour run 105 miles

I saw the most perfect green flash last night!

Oct 20

It was rough trying to eat dinner last night, lentil soup was all we could manage. Then at 2am we were motoring! Weather is so unpredictable here - changing every 12 hours or so. Been sailing all afternoon with a light west wind, turning NW, 2 1/2 knots. It is pleasant at least! We won't complain, lots of sun, easy to cook.

24 hour run 119 miles

Oct 21

We saw a nice green flash last night - went along with the perfect cloudless sky at sunrise. Today is not so pretty - gray, blue clouds marching along, kind of breaking up as they pass over. Seems to be a stalled-out front, NW winds to 25 knots today. Ann Lotte is flying! 6-7 knots steady. We are reeling down the latitude, in the 30's now - brrr!

24 hour run - 117 miles

Oct 23

Oops - skipped a day - it was awful, motored into South winds. Still motoring today, at least we see land. Want to get this over with - I'd not need head winds the last 2 days. Longfall at sundown - Rye to adventure, hi to grim reality.

cont

Landfall wasn't so bad after all - the sun came out, the wind came up lightly from the east and we sailed! Lots of birds on the water, big ones with yellow heads, white and black. The hills are green, very rugged. Sailboats everywhere!

Oka is in the mauna! We met them on Lazy Lightning and cruised Trinidad & Venezuela. Ed and Fran, they have been here for 12 years. Wed Nov 13

Tore ourselves away from Opua - it was difficult, as more people we knew kept coming in. Orec Halcum anchored next to us and Ken loved eating the mussels off the mooring buoys! Leo on Moonlight arrived, Bob & Robin on Buster, Joyce & Jack on 2nd Tri, Illusion, and Tanil & Annette on Kelebee. And who else - Lazy Lightning of course! We rented a car and visited Dave & Sue and the kids - Brian went to school with Ben and attended a symphony orchestra presentation in Auckland. Worked on the boat - bought a new stove, put up insulation because we were freezing! It is colder than we had anticipated - downright miserable at times. And windy!

But now we're under way to Gulf Harbor marina on Whangapara Peninsula, where Dave & Sue live. It is not easy sailing! Yesterday had 20-30, doing 7 knots under reefed main alone. Spent the night in Oke Bay, left early this morning to round Cape Brett. Motor sailed all day with light head winds - the curse of NZ. Stopped in Tutukaka - warm pleasant afternoon, very little wind, warm all bones.